



TAKE A LOOK—METAMORPHOSIS

Most invertebrates leave the egg as a larva and undergo several developmental stages before reaching adult form. This is known as metamorphosis.



◀ **CATERPILLAR** *After hatching from an egg, a butterfly caterpillar proceeds to eat and eat and eat. Its job is to grow quickly.*

▶ **TIME TO PUPATE** *A tough, leathery coat forms around the caterpillar, and it becomes a pupa. After some time, a butterfly will break free.*



▼ **ADULT FORM** *Finally, the butterfly emerges. It has to spread out its wings to dry before it can fly. A butterfly is the adult form.*



CNIDARIA



Sea anemone

This group includes sea jellies (also known as jellyfish), corals, and sea anemones. They have stinging cells called

nematocysts. Some can swim, while others remain fixed to the seabed, waiting for food to drift past.

▶ **BRAIN CORAL** *Many corals are named for their appearance, like this heavily wrinkled coral.*



▼ **SEA NETTLES** *Jellyfish, such as these sea nettles, have bodies that are largely made of water. Take a jellyfish out of water, and the shape will collapse.*



ECHINODERMATA

Many echinoderms have very spiny bodies and nearly all live on the seafloor—none can survive in fresh water. They include starfish (sea stars), sea urchins, and sea cucumbers. Most of these animals can move around, and they have up to 20 legs—but no brain.



Sunflower sea star

▶ **SEA CUCUMBER** *These echinoderms are found on seabeds all over the world.*



▼ **CROWN-OF-THORNS SEA STAR** *This is the largest starfish and a voracious predator, feeding on corals. It has needle-sharp spines, each capable of injecting a nasty venom.*



PORIFERA

Porifera are also called sponges. They were mistaken for plants until the 1700s but, in fact, are very simple animals, with no arms, legs, heads, or sense organs. Sponges have simple baglike or tubelike bodies and live stuck to the seafloor, filtering food from the water.



◀ **AZURE VASE SPONGE** *There are thousands of sea sponges, some very colorful.*

▼ **ELEPHANT EAR SPONGE** *Some sponge species can grow quite large. This one has reached 3 ft (1 m) in height and is still growing.*

